Chapter 1: The Rise of Nationalism in Europe 🌍 ⚔️

During the 19th century, nationalism emerged as a powerful force that swept across Europe, collapsing multi-national dynastic empires and paving the way for the modern "Nation-State". This chapter unveils the dramatic revolutions and intense unifications that shaped the borders of Europe as we know them today!

Master Mind Map 🗺️

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graph TD
    RNE[Rise of Nationalism] --> FS[Frederic Sorrieu's Vision 1848]
    RNE --> FR[The French Revolution 1789]

    FR --> NC[Napoleonic Code 1804]

    RNE --> MN[Making of Nationalism]
    MN --> A[Aristocracy & Middle Class]
    MN --> L[Liberal Nationalism - Freedom]
    MN --> C[Conservatism post-1815 Treaty of Vienna]

    RNE --> AR[Age of Revolutions 1830-1848]

    RNE --> U[Unifications]
    U --> G[Germany - Otto von Bismarck]
    U --> I[Italy - Mazzini, Garibaldi, Cavour]
    U --> B[Britain - Strange Case]
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1. Frederic Sorrieu & The French Revolution FR

In 1848, a French artist named **Frédéric Sorrieu** prepared a series of four magnificent prints visualizing his dream of a world made up of 'democratic and social Republics'.

- He visualized peoples of Europe and America marching towards the Statue of Liberty.
- The Statue bears the torch of Enlightenment and the Charter of the Rights of Man.
- **Nation-State:** A state wherein the majority of citizens share a sense of common identity, history, and descent.

The French Revolution (1789)

It was the first clear expression of nationalism in Europe. The revolution transferred power from absolute monarchy to a body of French citizens. **Steps taken to create a collective identity:**

1. The ideas of *la patrie* (the fatherland) and *le citoyen* (the citizen) emphasized a united community enjoying equal rights.
2. A new French flag (tricolour) replaced the royal standard.
3. The Estates General was elected by active citizens and renamed the National Assembly.
4. Internal customs duties were abolished, and a uniform system of weights and measures was adopted.

> [!NOTE] **Napoleonic Code (Civil Code of 1804):** Napoleon Bonaparte destroyed democracy in France, but in administrative fields, he made it highly rational. He abolished privileges based on birth, established equality before the law, and violently secured the right to property.

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2. The Making of Nationalism in Europe 🤝

During the mid-18th century, there were NO nation-states. Eastern and Central Europe were under autocratic monarchies holding diverse peoples (e.g., The Habsburg Empire).

Key Social Groups

- **The Aristocracy:** The socially and politically dominant landed class. They spoke French for diplomacy and were bound tightly by marriage ties.
- **The New Middle Class:** With industrialization, a new working-class and middle-class emerged (industrialists, businessmen, professionals). It was among these educated, liberal middle classes that ideas of national unity gained massive popularity.

What did Liberal Nationalism Stand for?

For the new middle classes, *liberalism* stood for **freedom for the individual** and **equality of all before the law**.

- **Politically:** It emphasized the concept of government by consent.
- **Economically:** It stood for the freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital (e.g., Zollverein—a massive customs union formed in 1834 at the initiative of Prussia).

A New Conservatism after 1815

Following the defeat of Napoleon in 1815, European governments were driven by a spirit of conservatism (traditional institutions, monarchy, church).

- **Treaty of Vienna (1815):** Hosted by the Austrian Chancellor Duke Metternich. The objective was to undo most changes brought by the Napoleonic wars and restore overthrown monarchies.

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3. The Unification of Germany and Italy DE IT

A. The Unification of Germany (1871)

- **Architect:** Otto von Bismarck, Chief Minister of Prussia.
- He carried out the process with the immense help of the Prussian army and bureaucracy.

- **Three wars over seven years** (with Austria, Denmark, and France) ended in Prussian victory and completed the bloody process of unification.
- In January 1871, the Prussian King, **William I**, was proclaimed German Emperor in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles.

B. The Unification of Italy (1861)

Italy was fragmented severely into seven states. Only Sardinia-Piedmont was ruled by an Italian princely house.

- **Giuseppe Mazzini:** Formed a secret society called *Young Italy* for the dissemination of goals.
- **Chief Minister Cavour:** Led the diplomatic movement to unify the regions. He allied strategically with France to defeat Austrian forces.
- **Giuseppe Garibaldi:** Led armed volunteers (Red Shirts). He marched into South Italy and drove out the Spanish rulers.
- In 1861, **Victor Emmanuel II** was proclaimed king of a united Italy.

> [!IMPORTANT] **The Strange Case of Britain:** Unlike the bloody wars in Germany and Italy, the formation of the nation-state in Britain was the result of a long, drawn-out parliamentary process, not sudden revolution. The English parliament slowly seized power from the monarchy in 1688, gradually annexing Scotland and Ireland under Protestant dominance.

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4. Visualizing the Nation 🎨

Artists in the 18th and 19th centuries found a way to personify a nation. They represented a country as if it were a person, mostly giving nations **female figures (Allegory)**.

1. **Marianne (France):** She represented the idea of a people's nation. Her statues were erected in public squares, and her image was marked on coins and stamps. Characteristics: The red cap, the tricolour, and the cockade.
2. **Germania (Germany):** She wore a crown of massive oak leaves, as the German oak magically stands for pure heroism.

Quick Revision Notes 📌

1. **French Revolution (1789)** was the explosive spark of modern European nationalism.
2. **Napoleonic Code (1804)** modernized administration but destroyed democracy.
3. **Treaty of Vienna (1815)** tried to turn back the clock to conservatism and monarchies.
4. **Otto von Bismarck** unified Germany ruthlessly using the Prussian military ("Blood and Iron").
5. **Cavour, Mazzini, and Garibaldi** were the iconic trio behind Italy's unification.
6. **Allegories** (Marianne and Germania) helped uneducated citizens physically visualize their invisible nations.

Chapter Summary 🏁

The rise of Nationalism fundamentally rewrote the map of Europe. Triggered vividly by the explosive French Revolution, the concept of a "Nation-State" spread like wildfire. Despite harsh pushback from conservative monarchs in 1815, educated middle classes continually fought for liberal constitutionalism. This unstoppable momentum ultimately culminated in the incredible, complex military unifications of both Germany and Italy in the 1870s, changing the global geopolitical balance forever!